

TIRRA General Meeting

Thursday, November 25, 2021, 7:00PM

President Wendy Hinsperger called the meeting to order at 7:00 PM with the following also present:

- Quentin Goodbody, Vice President
- Treasurer and Solid Waste Chairperson, Ernie Hunter
- St. Margaret's Cemetery Chairperson, Suzanne Sarioglu
- Trails Chairperson, Vicki Walker
- Transportation Chairperson, Stu Downey
- Welcome Chairperson, vacant
- Absent: Espokes Chairperson, Claire Hess and Secretary, Lisa Vernon

Wendy Hinsperger welcomed all and thanked them for their participation. 16 attendees: quorum met.

The Minutes of the TIRRA Annual General Meeting on Saturday, June 26, 2021 were approved as found online, motion by Keith Rush, seconded by Quentin Goodbody; approved.

TIRRA Executive Committee Reports are online, brief discussions were held on reports as submitted.

<http://www.thetisland.net/tica-tirra/tirra-reports.htm>

President's Report: Wendy is working with 6 other members of the community to continue to investigate centralized composting as a sustainable program. Group will next meet in early December.

Cemetery Report: Suzanne advised her call out for new community members to join the cemetery committee happily resulted in two new members: Dave Reay and Georgina Webber. Our thanks to them.

Transportation Report: Stu Downey reported that the recent rainfall caused flooding in a few culverts, but fortunately no damage. Residents with driveways that slope down to common roadways should ensure run-off management on their properties so that mud and debris does not flow onto paved areas. Residents are encouraged to report any rockfall on Moore Hill to Joe at the Emcon Yard 250 246-3431 as each rockfall is recorded. Emcon can also be contacted 24/7 using their Road Reporting Line at 1 866 353-3136. For all emergencies dial 911.

Trails Report: Vicki advised some flooding. Signage indicating trails are closed have been ordered, which can be moved throughout the trail system if hazards arise. For your safety, take care in flooded areas of trails at this time! Thank you to Pat English for her technical support to Vicki.

Treasurer's Report: Ernie reports overall financials are healthy. No significant items reported since year end Dec 2020. No parcel tax will be requested this year (2022 taxes), as sufficient funds are on hand to operate as we were before the Covid-19 shut down.

Solid Waste Report: No report posted online. Ernie verbally reports that though recycle reopening has no specific date, headway is being made. The reopening is imminent. Now that we know CVRD will not take unbaled product, we are seeking a solution through GFL. The goal is to find the most economical

way to gather unbaled product and ship it at a reasonable rate. (The role of baler is not considered sustainable due to weights requiring hand lifting.)

There will definitely be some changes in what can be received at TI recycle, it will initially be more like the blue box system utilized on VI.

Paul Duncan continues his independent review looking at all aspects of site operation: costs, risks, safety, sustainability. This review once complete, will be shared so all islanders have a chance to consider the findings. The review is intended to ensure we have an efficient, green, responsible and economical operation in place for the future. The reopening of recycle is not dependent on this review. Lucy Mooney made the following motion: TIRRA Solid Waste Facility to consider hiring an appropriate person to manage facilities to be funded through parcel tax. Vicki seconded. Discussion of pros and cons, including but not limited to dedicated resource, providing on island employment opportunity, perhaps should wait for Paul's independent review findings, GFL arrangements still pending, would job be robust enough if no baling.

Vote: 7 in favour, 9 opposed, motion lost.

Ron Bannister suggested that TIRRA summarize to CVRD, via letter, to relay our disappointment in not receiving appropriate assistance/flexibility from CVRD staff to facilitate a recycle restart.

Espokes: Claire was absent; refer to online report: everything is going well.

Ferries: Keith Rush provided an update on several ferry matters: new schedule is working well. A review underway regarding commercial vehicles and dangerous cargo sailings. Staffing issues on other ferry routes during the recent floods, did not impact Chemainus operations. Interesting stats: 2021 YTD 51,398 vehicle round trips, versus 2019 same period 51,456. Passengers 2021 YTD 119,083, versus 2019 same YTD 148,672. New signage clarifying stop line for ferry traffic.

Rainfall stats: rainiest month Jan 2020: 379mm vs Nov 2021 to date 327mm.

New Business:

- TIRRA is required to recommend board members for the TIPC Board (Thetis Island Port Commission): one vacancy to be filled starting Jan 2022. If you are interested, please contact tirra@thetisland.net
- Looking for Welcome Chairperson (involves ordering materials, preparing packages and having a Thetis Islander drop off the package for a face-to-face introduction); advise interest at tirra@thetisland.net
- Meeting dates and times for TIRRA: Would more residents attend if general meetings held on a Saturday. No strong feelings, has been tried before. TIRRA will try a Saturday timeslot for next GM.
- Recent calls for TIRRA to assist taxpayers in having RCMP attend for petty crime and nuisance issues. TIRRA will organize a fireside chat session in the spring with the RCMP. Any islanders wanting to help plan this event, please contact tirra@thetisland.net

Wendy adjourned the meeting at 8:35 PM